

Complete Fteri Beach Travel Guide

Fteri Beach • Kefalonia, Greece

Quick overview

Fteri Beach is one of Kefalonia's most spectacular secluded beaches, known for white pebbles, turquoise water and dramatic limestone cliffs. It is near Zola and is normally reached by boat or hiking trail.

1. Where is Fteri Beach?

- Fteri Beach is on the Paliki Peninsula in northwestern Kefalonia, close to Zola.
- There is no direct road to the beach; access is mainly by water taxi or hiking.
- Its limited access helps preserve its natural character.

2. How to get there

- The easiest option is a water taxi from Zola Harbor. The boat ride is roughly 10 minutes, depending on the operator and sea conditions.
- The hiking route is roughly 2 km and may take around 40–60 minutes downhill; the uphill return is harder.
- Confirm boat schedules and return pickup arrangements before departure.

3. Boat vs. hiking

- Boat: easiest, fast, scenic and suitable for most travelers.
- Hike: adventurous and rewarding for fit travelers, but the route can be rocky, steep and hot.
- You can potentially hike down and arrange a boat pickup back, but confirm the pickup first.

4. Estimated costs

- Water-taxi prices vary by season and operator. A published example has listed about €20 return, but verify the current price.
- Also budget for transport to Zola, food, water and any private-boat or excursion charges.
- Local prices and services can change.

5. What makes Fteri special

- White pebbles, clear turquoise water, dramatic white limestone cliffs and green Mediterranean vegetation.
- Excellent for swimming, snorkeling, photography and quiet relaxation.
- It is an undeveloped beach, without the typical rows of sunbeds and beach clubs.

6. Best time to visit

- June–September is generally the most practical summer period.
- July and August are hottest and busiest; arrive early.
- September is an excellent choice for warm water and potentially fewer visitors.
- October–May is less predictable and seasonal boat services may be limited.

7. Best time of day

- Morning is ideal for cooler temperatures, softer light and fewer visitors.

- Aim for roughly 8:00–10:00 AM arrival when practical.
- The beach can become busier later as more boats arrive.

8. Things to do

- Swim in the clear Ionian Sea.
- Snorkel around suitable rocky areas without touching coral.
- Photograph the cliffs, turquoise water and boat approach.
- Relax on the beach and enjoy the natural surroundings.

9. Facilities

- Fteri is an unorganised beach.
- Do not expect a restaurant, beach bar, sunbeds, umbrellas, showers, changing rooms or shops.
- Bring everything you need for your visit.

10. What to bring

- Plenty of drinking water and food/snacks.
- Sunscreen, hat, sunglasses and towel.
- Snorkeling equipment and a waterproof phone case/dry bag.
- Proper hiking shoes if using the trail.
- Beach shade/umbrella if staying for several hours.
- Power bank, some cash and basic first-aid supplies.

11. Where to stay

- Zola: best if Fteri is your main priority because it is close to the boat departure area.
- Lixouri: practical for restaurants, supermarkets, accommodation and exploring Paliki.
- Argostoli: more accommodation, restaurants and nightlife, with a central base for the island.
- Fiskardo: beautiful and upscale but farther from Fteri.

12. Food

- There are no normal food facilities on Fteri Beach.
- Plan for hotel breakfast, packed lunch/snacks and plenty of water, followed by dinner in Zola or Lixouri.
- If using an excursion, check whether food and drinks are included.

13. Other places to visit

- Myrtos Beach, Petani Beach, Antisamos Beach, Xi Beach, Melissani Cave and Assos village are excellent additions to a Kefalonia trip.

14. Ideal 5-day itinerary

- Day 1: Arrive, check in, explore locally and enjoy sunset.
- Day 2: Early water taxi to Fteri; swim, snorkel, photograph and relax; return to Zola/Lixouri.
- Day 3: Myrtos Beach and Assos.
- Day 4: Melissani Cave, Karavomilos, Antisamos Beach and Sami.

- Day 5: Petani Beach, Lixouri, shopping and departure preparations.

15. Rough budget

- Budget planning: approximately €50–€80/day.
- Comfortable: approximately €100–€180/day.
- Luxury: €200+/day.
- These are broad estimates; accommodation, car rental, restaurants and excursions can change the total substantially.

16. Rental car

- A rental car is recommended because Kefalonia's attractions are spread across the island.
- It makes combining Fteri with Myrtos, Assos, Petani, Argostoli, Melissani and Antisamos much easier.
- For Fteri, drive to Zola and take a water taxi from the harbor.

17. Safety & responsible travel

- Check weather and sea conditions before going.
- Do not underestimate the hiking route, especially the uphill return.
- Avoid midday hiking in hot weather and carry enough water.
- Do not touch coral or take marine life.
- Take rubbish with you and follow boat-crew safety instructions.

18. Photography

- Great viewpoints include the boat approach, beach looking toward the cliffs, trail panorama and water-level views.
- Early morning gives softer light and a quieter beach.
- Check local rules before using a drone.

19. Is Fteri Beach worth visiting?

- Yes. It is especially good for travelers seeking a natural, secluded beach rather than a developed resort.
- Best for couples, photographers, swimmers, snorkelers, nature lovers, hikers and boat-trip enthusiasts.
- Recommended plan: stay in Lixouri or Argostoli, rent a car, drive to Zola, take an early water taxi, spend several hours at Fteri and return by boat.

Travel note: Prices, boat schedules, facilities, road conditions and entry requirements can change. Confirm current details with your accommodation, boat operator and local authorities before travel.